

YURI GAGARIN

1934-1968

Gagarin's short height was essential to fit into the capsule.

History was made on 12 April 1961 when, for the first time, a human left our planet and travelled into space. Yuri Gagarin, a 27-year-old Russian pilot, was launched into space in a capsule called Vostok 1. Gagarin made one orbit of Earth in 108 minutes and landed safely.

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: First human in space



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Russia



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1961